

THIRD-PARTY TWEAK UTILITIES

Here are third-party tweak utilities that allow you to further enhance the performance of Windows XP

Tweak XP

This tweak utility allows you to not only tweak Windows XP but also your system settings. You can optimise your system by



Make your taskbar look transparent with Tweak XP

freeing RAM, applying tweaks to your CPU, tweaking your Internet settings by blocking advertisements, shredding files, allowing certain programs to be used by certain users only, and so on. With this software you can make your Windows taskbar transparent by going to **System + Files Tweaks > Make the taskbar transparent**.

Power Toys

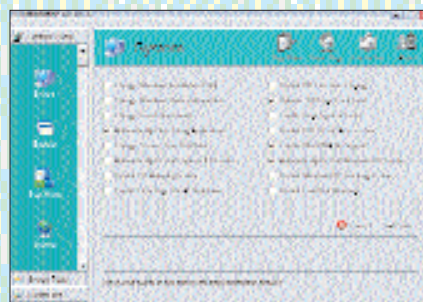
This program bundles a set of small programs such as Tweak UI, Image Resizer, Super Fast User Switcher, Power Calculator, etc which let you perform functions such as switch users without having to go

to the logon screen, create graphs and evaluate functions, among others.

Customiser XP

Customiser XP is a special utility designed to optimise the performance of Windows 2000 and XP. Using a graphical user interface, it allows you to modify many hidden Windows registry settings by simply clicking the provided checkboxes. Customiser XP helps

you improve your Internet connection as it sets all recommended settings for you at the click of a speci-



Automatically restart Windows using Customiser XP in case of a crash

fied button. It also offers a wide range of possibilities to customise your Windows program, such as choosing a background of

your choice at pre-logon and automatically restarting Windows Explorer when it crashes while you're working to avoid losing your work.

Styles XP

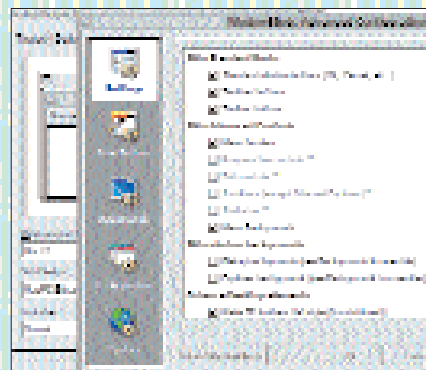
Windows XP has a limited set of themes. In order to add more themes you can use Styles XP which provides a good variety of colours and themes. In order to change the various themes supported by this program, right-click on your desktop and go to **Properties > Themes**, and select a theme of your choice. You can change the

colours from the Appearance tab, which is right next to the Themes tab.

Windows Blind

Want to give your OS a Mac look? You can do so through the Windows Blind program.

All you need to do is install the program and navigate to the themes. You will find the option for loading a Macintosh theme. If your



Set a Mac theme for Windows with Windows Blind

machine does not have enough memory, put it on enhanced mode or opt for 'High performance' if you have a powerful machine.

Desktop X

This program lets you build your own customised desktop. As is the case with all third-party software which let you change the style, this one lets you load a particular style as well, except that here you can also edit the style, change the buttons, make particular themes for particular programs, and more. Right-click on the desktop, go to **Properties > Appearance**, and click on the Windows Blind button. This will let you modify the settings. In case you don't want to use any of the styles but want to keep the program, then just unload Windows Blind.